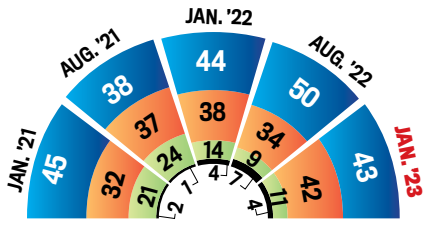
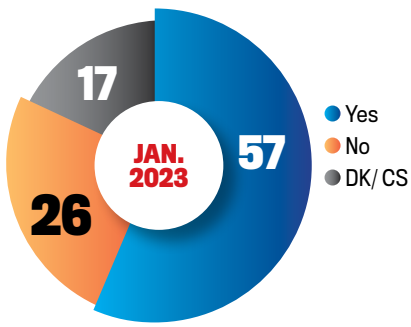
Q HAS INDIA BECOME SAFER OR LESS SAFE FOR WOMEN?

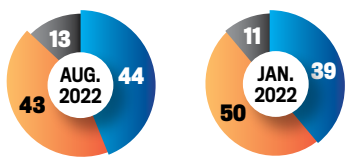


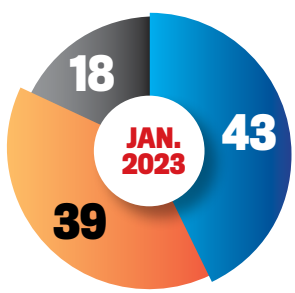
Become safer for women Become less safe for women Remained the same DK/ CS

Q SHOULD INDIA BAN THE HIJAB IN EDUCATIONAL INSTITUTIONS?



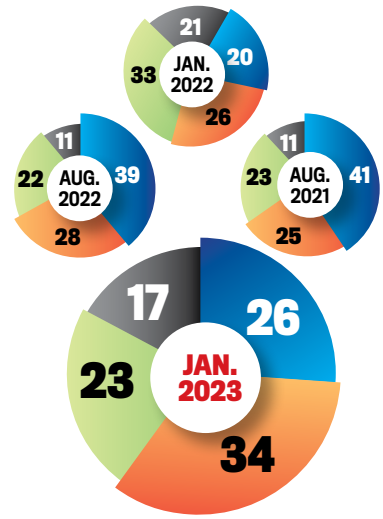
Q SHOULD INDIA LEGALISE CANNABIS (GANJA)?





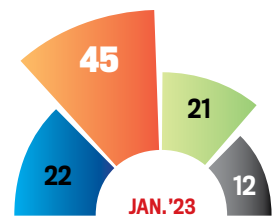
Yes No DK/ CS

Q WHAT SHOULD THE UNION GOVERNMENT DO TO RESTORE "NORMALCY" IN JAMMU & KASHMIR?



Restore full statehood without Article 370 Restore full statehood and Article 370 Let it remain a UT DK/ CS

Q ARE OUR EFFORTS TO PROTECT THE ENVIRONMENT SUFFICIENT?



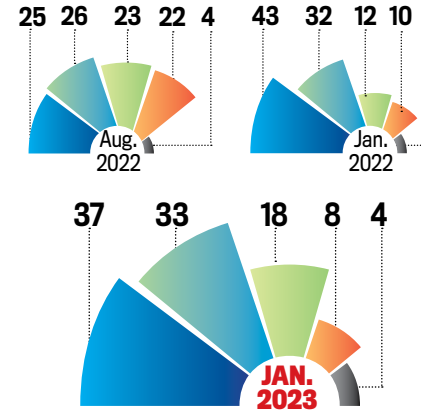
Completely sufficient Somewhat sufficient Completely insufficient DK/ CS

76%

RESPONDENTS ARE READY TO ACCEPT INTER-CASTE MARRIAGES AND 69 PER CENT ARE FINE WITH INTER-RELIGIOUS MARRIAGES

All figures in % and rounded off; DK/ CS: Don't know/ Can't say

Q DO YOU CONSIDER YOURSELF HAPPY?



Yes, very happy Yes, somewhat happy No, unhappy to some extent No, totally unhappy DK/ CS

safe, compared to 34 per cent in August 2022. Data bears out the public view. According to the National Crime Records Bureau, of the 6 million crimes recorded in India between January 1 and December 31 in 2022, 428,278 cases were crimes against women—the highest in six years. While states are doing their bit—be it installing street lights or setting up emergency helplines for women's safety—experts insist what's needed is a combination of strict laws and change in mindset.

The past few months have seen a fair share of ups and downs. Worries about Covid-19 seem to have receded, but economic uncertainty, growing suspicion of minorities, rising crimes against women continue to weigh on people's minds. But a majority say they are happy; overall, there is support for uniformity, liberalism and democracy. Interestingly, even at the peak of the Omicron wave in January 2022, most people said they were happy. Perhaps happiness isn't rooted in the day-to-day, but in the hope for a better tomorrow. ■